

Building the AArch32 and AArch64 ports

μOS++ III SMP

Building the AArch32 and AArch64 ports

Everything needed to go from empty directory to twenty-four test images per architecture, running under QEMU or on a Raspberry Pi.

1. Get the sources

Each architecture project keeps **no copy** of the kernel or the drivers. Clone what you need side by side:

```
mkdir workspace && cd workspace
git clone <remote>/micro-os-plus-iii-smp.git
git clone <remote>/micro-os-plus-iii-devices.git
git clone <remote>/micro-os-plus-iii-aarch64.git      # and/or -aarch32
```

```
workspace/
├─ micro-os-plus-iii-smp/
├─ micro-os-plus-iii-devices/
├─ micro-os-plus-iii-aarch64/
└─ micro-os-plus-iii-aarch32/
```

CMake finds them as siblings. Override either with

```
cmake -DUOS_SMP_DIR=/elsewhere/micro-os-plus-iii-smp \
      -DUOS_DEVICES_DIR=/elsewhere/micro-os-plus-iii-devices ...
```

A build that cannot find one stops and names the repository to clone.

One kernel working copy serves every architecture project on the machine, so an edit to it is visible to all of them at once — no submodule pointer to bump, no commit–push–pull round trip.

2. Tools

Tool	Used for	Notes
<code>arm-none-eabi-gcc</code> 15	aarch32	xPack
<code>aarch64-none-elf-gcc</code> 15	aarch64, and the AArch32 QEMU boot shim	xPack
CMake ≥ 3.20	both	
<code>qemu-system-aarch64</code>	both suites	xPack QEMU 9.x
python3 + <code>markdown</code> , <code>weasyprint</code>	<code>docs/md2pdf.py</code>	docs only

Toolchains are found under `~/.local/xPacks/@xpack-dev-tools/`, newest first, falling back to `PATH`. Pin one exactly with

```
cmake -DUOS_TOOLCHAIN_BIN=~/.local/xPacks/@xpack-dev-tools/aarch64-none-elf-gcc/
15.2.1-1.1.1/.content/bin ...
```

3. Configure and build

AArch64 — Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W / Pi 3 B, 4× Cortex-A53, ARMv8-A

```
cd micro-os-plus-iii-aarch64
cmake -S . -B build \
    -DCMAKE_TOOLCHAIN_FILE=../micro-os-plus-iii-smp/cmake/toolchains/aarch64-none-elf.cmake
cmake --build build -j8
```

AArch32 — same silicon in 32-bit mode, ARMv7-A

```
cd micro-os-plus-iii-aarch32
cmake -S . -B build \
    -DCMAKE_TOOLCHAIN_FILE=../micro-os-plus-iii-smp/cmake/toolchains/arm-none-eabi.cmake
cmake --build build -j8
```

Board

```
cmake -S . -B build-rpi3b -DBOARD=rpi3b ...    # default: zero2w
```

`rpi3b` selects `linker-rpi3b.ld` and defines `BOARD_RPI3B`.

What you get

24 targets — twelve applications × {qemu, hwd} — each producing an ELF, a .bin (the kernel8.img / kernel7.img equivalent) and a .map, all in build/test/.

```
sd_test-qemu      sd_test-hwd
smp_test0..4-qemu smp_test0..4-hwd
smp-mat-test-qemu smp-mat-test-hwd
smp-mat-sdcard-test-... smp-num-test-...
smp-pipeline-test-... smp-pro-cons-test-...
usb_test-qemu     usb_test-hwd
```

qemu is the emulator build. hwd adds HW_BUILD (SD tests use the existing FAT32 boot partition rather than formatting a blank card) and DEBUG_BOOT (early-boot asm markers for OpenOCD bring-up).

4. Running the QEMU suites

One runner serves every architecture; the caller supplies the machine.

AArch64 — straight to -kernel

```
../micro-os-plus-iii-smp/test/run-qemu.sh build/test \
    "${ls ~/.local/xPacks/@xpack-dev-tools/qemu-arm/*.content/bin/qemu-system-aarch64 | tail -1}" \
    -M raspi3b -smp 4
```

AArch32 — through the boot shim

QEMU's raspi3b starts its Cortex-A53 cores in AArch64, so a 20-line stub drops to AArch32 and jumps to the image. CMake builds it as qemu-shim.

```
UOS_QEMU_SHIM=build/test/shim8.img UOS_QEMU_LOAD_ADDR=0x10000 \
../micro-os-plus-iii-smp/test/run-qemu.sh build/test \
    "${ls ~/.local/xPacks/@xpack-dev-tools/qemu-arm/*.content/bin/qemu-system-aarch64 | tail -1}" \
    -M raspi3b -smp 4
```

Not raspi2b. The port is built -mcpu=cortex-a53, so its load-acquire instructions are undefined on the raspi2b Cortex-A7 and the image faults at the first one. Hardware needs no shim at all: config.txt sets arm_64bit=0 and the cores come up in AArch32 directly.

The runner creates the SD images the four card tests need — a seeded flatfs volume for sd_test, a blank 4 GiB image for the others — under build/test/.qemu-logs/.

Run one suite at a time. Two four-core suites at once, or one alongside a build, starves a QEMU vCPU: a worker freezes mid-loop with no fault, which looks exactly like a deadlock. Re-run on an idle host before investigating.

Result

```
qemu suite: 11 passed, 1 skipped, 0 failed
```

on both architectures. `usb_test` skips by design — QEMU emulates no USB device mode — exactly as the predecessor suite recorded it.

5. Running on hardware

Measured on a Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W over a SEGGER J-Link.

Port	Hardware
AArch64	all twelve tests pass
AArch32	<code>usb_test</code> passes; the other eleven are built but not yet run on silicon

Only what has actually been run on the board is recorded here. The AArch32 figure is not inferred from the AArch64 one — the two ports share every test source, but they are separate binaries and a stale build is indistinguishable from a bug until you rebuild and re-run.

Standalone boot

Flash a `*-hwd.bin` as `kernel8.img` (AArch64) or `kernel7.img` (AArch32) on the boot partition, with the port's `config.txt` from `boards/rpi-zero-2w/`.

Debug-in-RAM, through OpenOCD

```
cd micro-os-plus-iii-aarch64      # or -aarch32
test/hw.sh list                   # the tests this build has, and their budgets
test/hw.sh smp_test2              # run one
```

`test/hw.sh` holds only what is specific to the ISA — the binutils, the entry fallback, the width of `__smp_spin`, whether a core resumes by setting the PC (AArch64) or by forcing CPSR first (AArch32), and whether the OpenOCD config initialises itself. The session is driven by `test/run-hw.sh` in the kernel repository, which every port shares. Together they replace the predecessor's `hw.sh` + `hw-olimex.sh` in each test directory of each port: 48 files of about 200 near-identical lines.

It is **pure OpenOCD** — no GDB, no reset, and it never opens the serial device, so it cannot fight the terminal you keep on the console. Keep your own `tio -b 115200 /dev/ttyACM0` running; the verdict is read from the semihosted console in OpenOCD's log.

One test per power cycle. Every run is `load_image` into RAM over whatever the previous test left there, and the Pi has no SRST — the Cortex-A53 debug target has no reset method a script can drive. So `run-hw.sh` takes exactly one test and refuses a suite. Power-cycle between tests.

Env	Meaning
<code>PROBE</code>	<code>jlink</code> (default) or <code>olimex</code>
<code>BUILD</code>	the CMake build directory (default <code>build</code>)
<code>UOS_HW_ADAPTER_KHZ</code>	override the JTAG clock. <code>board/rpi3.cfg</code> asks for 4000 kHz, more than jumper wires always carry. A DAP that gives up mid-run prints <code>Invalid ACK (0) in DAP response</code> and then fails to re-examine every core; the runner reports that as DEBUG LINK LOST , not as a firmware fault.

The third argument overrides the run budget in seconds. A budget is **not** the test's own duration: it is dominated by semihosting traps, and those scale with how much a test prints. `smp_test4` reaches its verdict at t=9597 ms of target time yet needs well over 120 s of wall clock, because its reporter emits about nine lines a second and each is a debug halt and resume over JTAG.

The boot card

The four SD tests and `usb_test` mount the card's **existing** FAT32 partition through FatFs and keep every file under `tests/`. They never format it and never touch the root. `boards/rpi-zero-2w/verify-bootcard.py` proves that byte-for-byte under QEMU.

FatFs is built without long-name support, so a file arrives on the card as an 8.3 name in upper case — `xfer.bin` is stored as `XFER.BIN`, and the device says so.

`usb_test` needs a host

It is the only test QEMU cannot run at all, and the only one that needs something done on the host while it runs.

Power the board from `PWR IN` and run the data cable from the PC to the `USB` socket — the OTG port. On the wrong socket the board boots and prints normally but never enumerates, with no error message.

```
test/hw.sh usb_test 900          # one terminal
# ~20 s later, in another:
cd ../micro-os-plus-iii-smp/test/common/usb_test
sudo ./host_xfer.py
```

With no arguments `host_xfer.py` runs the size matrix — 0, 1, 511, 512, 513, 1024, 65536, 1048576 bytes, each written and read back with CRC checks — then a `LIST`, then the terminating `PING` that makes the device print its tally and `RESULT`. Without that ping the device serves commands for ever and never reaches a verdict. `send_file.py` is the single-file demo and terminates only with `--terminate`.

The verdict is `crc_errors == 0 && commands != 0 && active >= 3`: at least three of the four cores must have run the unpinned load generators, which is what makes it an SMP test and not only a USB one.

Defects this suite found

Hardware exercised paths QEMU cannot, and five of them were real:

Defect	Why only on hardware
Every blinking test drove GPIO16	<code>led.hpp</code> falls back to header pin 36; the Zero 2 W's onboard ACT LED is GPIO29. Only <code>usb_test</code> had ever set <code>LED_PIN</code> . It is a board fact now, set once for every test.
<code>usb_test</code> replied to a PUT after its console output	The reply is sent immediately after the store now. The hexdump and listing are queue posts drained one semihosting trap at a time, so a completed store looked like a hang.
Console posts blocked the USB service thread	They use <code>try_send</code> now and are dropped when the consumer falls behind, with <code>console_dropped</code> in the tally. Diagnostics must never throttle the protocol.
<code>LIST</code> compared names case-sensitively	fatfs under QEMU keeps the name as sent; FatFs on the card returns <code>XFER.BIN</code> .
<code>kOutChunkMax</code> overflowed <code>PKTCNT</code>	<code>D{I,0}EPTSIZ</code> is bounded by <i>two</i> fields. This core reports <code>GHWCFG3 = 0x0ff000e8</code> : XFRSIZ 19 bits (524287 bytes) but PKTCNT 10 bits — 1023 packets , so 65472 bytes at full speed. The old <code>0x7F000</code> was sized against XFRSIZ alone and against 512-byte packets, and asked for 8128 packets in a 10-bit field. A 1 MiB transfer stored 61440 bytes, truncated. 65536 was the last size to pass because it overflows the field by exactly one packet.

`DEBUG_BOOT` is off by default in the `hwd` builds, as the sources assume — each early-boot marker is a semihosting trap. `-DUOS_DEBUG_BOOT=ON` restores them for board bring-up.

6. Declaring your own application

```
uos_add_app (my_app
  SOURCES      main.cpp
  PORT         micro-os-plus::aarch64
  LIBRARIES     micro-os-plus::devices
  LINKER_SCRIPT ${CMAKE_CURRENT_SOURCE_DIR}/linker.ld
  NCPU         4
  DEFINES      TRACE __ARM_EABI__ SEMIHOST
)
```

`uos_add_app` links the kernel, sets `OS_NCPU` (and `OS_USE_SMP_SCHEDULER` when it exceeds 1), applies the bare-metal flag set, adds the linker script, and emits the `.bin` and a size listing. It replaces the 214 Makefiles the predecessor repository carried, which differed by about 48 lines of boilerplate each.

To build one of the shared tests instead:

```
uos_add_test_app (smp_test1 NCPU 4 LINKER_SCRIPT ... DEFINES ...)
```

which resolves the sources from `test/common/smp_test1/`. No build ever spells out a path into the test tree.

7. CMake targets exported

micro-os-plus-iii-smp

Target	Contents
<code>micro-os-plus::iii</code>	the kernel core: 37 sources every port compiles
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-posix-io</code>	13 sources, the file-descriptor layer
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-drivers</code>	2
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-startup</code>	the generic reset path — a port with its own <code>startup.S</code> skips it
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-newlib-reent</code>	1
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-semihosting</code>	1
<code>micro-os-plus::iii-trace-itm</code> / <code>-trace-semihosting</code> / <code>-trace-segger-rtt</code>	mutually exclusive; link at most one
<code>micro-os-plus::port-smp-decls</code>	the shared <code>os-decls.h</code>
<code>micro-os-plus::test-common</code>	the shared test support

The ARM ports link the core, `port-smp-decls` and `test-common`, and **none** of the optional groups. Linking `iii-posix-io` into a newlib bare-metal build fails to compile: it declares `read/write` returning `ssize_t` where newlib declares `int`.

`micro-os-plus-iii-devices`

Target	Contents
<code>micro-os-plus::devices</code>	SD, flatfs, DWC2, FatFs
<code>micro-os-plus::soc-bcm2837</code>	BCM2837 registers, IRQ, mailbox

The architecture projects

`micro-os-plus::aarch32`, `micro-os-plus::aarch64` — each links `micro-os-plus::iii`, `micro-os-plus::port-smp-decls` and `micro-os-plus::soc-bcm2837`, and carries its `-mcpu` as both a compile and a **link** option. Without the machine flags at link time the driver picks the wrong multilib and every AArch32 link fails with *"uses VFP register arguments"*.

8. Defines

See `smp-construction.md` §5 for the complete table, per folder: what the port header fixes, what `uos_add_app` sets, what each architecture project's `test/CMakeLists.txt` adds, and which of the kernel's many optional `OS_*` switches matter (none of them, for these builds).

9. Rebuilding this document

```
python3 docs/md2pdf.py docs/building-aarch32-aarch64.md docs/building-aarch32-aarch64.pdf \  
  --title "Building the AArch32 and AArch64 ports" \  
  --subtitle "µOS++ III SMP" \  
  --footer "µOS++ III SMP – build guide"
```